



TENSOR STRENGTH

# THE HUTCH TOUCH

ATHLETE EDITION

Advanced / Intuitive Programming

## THE STANDARD

Control. Stability. Strength. Power. Expression. Every phase earns the next.

SERIOUS TRAINING // INTENTIONAL PROGRESSION // COMPLETE ATHLETIC PERFORMANCE

# THIS IS NOT A CASUAL PROGRAM

The Hutch Touch is built for serious athletes and serious lifters who want meaningful gains in strength, stability, power, muscular endurance, work capacity, speed, and general fitness. Do not begin this system expecting to coast through it. The sessions are demanding by design, but every hard effort is controlled by technique, RPE, recovery, and intelligent exercise selection.

This is the training philosophy I use personally to build high-level strength and athleticism at roughly 175 lb bodyweight. Performance markers include a 600 lb deadlift, 500 lb squat, 360 lb bench press, 315 lb HBT zombie squat, 405 lb BOSU-ball RDL, and 300 lb HBT bench press. Outside the weight room, that same approach has supported marathon and ultra-marathon distances, a 36-inch vertical, and a recorded 3:30 per kilometer pace over 5 kilometers.

## THE POINT

Do not copy the numbers. Copy the standard: master control, own unstable positions, build strength, express power, and then bring all of it back to the competition or primary movement.

## WHAT THIS PROGRAM TRAINS

### CONTROL

Tempo, pauses, bracing, and clean positions before load becomes the priority.

### STABILITY

HBT and other demanding variations expose weak links and force the system to organize under load.

### STRENGTH

Low-rep compound work builds force without turning every session into a max test.

### POWER

Banded and explosive work teaches the athlete to apply force quickly.

### ENDURANCE

High-volume accessories and short conditioning finishes build work capacity.

### EXPRESSION

The block returns to the primary lift so the new qualities show up where they matter.

## WHO SHOULD USE IT

This edition assumes advanced exercise literacy and the ability to self-regulate. It intentionally leaves room for athlete-level judgment.

# THE HUTCH TOUCH SYSTEM

The program runs as a four-session rotation, not a Monday-through-Sunday calendar. Complete the next appropriate session when recovery and movement quality support it.

| ROTATION | SESSION           | PRIMARY EMPHASIS                 | ANCHOR           |
|----------|-------------------|----------------------------------|------------------|
| 01       | Upper Body Push   | Bench + pressing volume          | Bench variation  |
| 02       | Lower Body Pull   | Deadlift skill + posterior chain | Sumo deadlift    |
| 03       | Upper Body Pull   | High-volume back + arms          | Weighted chin-up |
| 04       | Legs / Lower Push | Squat strength + leg volume      | Squat variation  |

## PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD - NOT JUST MORE WEIGHT

The main overload method is variation progression. Early variations are deliberately more demanding in control, stability, or position. Later variations become more mechanically efficient, more powerful, and finally more specific to the primary lift.

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>LOAD RECALIBRATION</b> | <b>Every variation change requires a new load.</b> Do not carry the same weight forward just because the next variation looks easier. Ramp up again and select the load that honestly matches the prescribed RPE. As the movement becomes mechanically easier, the appropriate working load will usually rise. |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### 1. RAMP

Use 3-5 progressive warm-up sets when entering a new main-lift variation.

### 2. CALIBRATE

Make the first work set conservative. Adjust load until the target RPE is honest.

### 3. OWN IT

Only count clean reps. Position, speed, and stability matter as much as the number on the bar.

### 4. ADVANCE

Move to the next variation when the exposure is technically successful; repeat it if execution is not there.

## RPE QUICK GUIDE

| RPE | APPROX. REPS IN RESERVE | USE IN THIS PROGRAM                                      |
|-----|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 7   | ~3                      | Technical practice / low-fatigue primary deadlift        |
| 8   | ~2                      | Most main-lift work and hard compounds                   |
| 9   | ~1                      | High-effort squat work and selected accessories          |
| 10  | 0                       | Not a default target; avoid routine failure on compounds |

# ATHLETE EDITION - AUTOREGULATION

This edition mirrors the way the system is actually used: the rotation is stable, but the athlete can change the next session, repeat a variation, or temporarily run a tighter push/pull/legs rhythm when total life stress is low.

## FEEL SHARP

Run the next session normally. If the movement feels exceptional, earn the top end of the prescribed RPE - do not exceed it.

## LOCAL FATIGUE

Move to a session that does not heavily load the fatigued tissue. Keep the rotation moving without forcing overlap.

## SYSTEMIC FATIGUE

Keep the training day but trim accessory volume 20-30%, or take a recovery day if bar speed and coordination are clearly off.

## WEAK POINT SHOWING

Repeat or insert a related variation. Example: add a box squat exposure if positional strength is the limiting factor.

## LOW LIFE STRESS

The athlete may compress recovery and use a more traditional PPL rhythm for a short period if performance stays high.

## PAIN / ALTERED MECHANICS

Do not rationalize it as hard training. Change the movement or stop the provoking pattern and resolve the issue.

## THE RULE

Intuition is earned by experience. Autoregulation changes the route, not the standard. RPE, technical quality, and the purpose of the phase still govern the session.

# SESSION 01 - UPPER BODY PUSH

Bench strength first, then high-volume shoulder and triceps work. The warm-up primes the shoulder complex without turning into a fatigue session.

|                      |                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>WARM-UP ORDER</b> | Plyometric / explosive work -> core and stability -> mobility -> movement patterning -> ramp-up sets into the main lift. |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| WARM-UP                                   | SETS / REPS          | INTENT                                    |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Ab wheel                                  | 2 x 6-10             | Core + scapular engagement                |
| Core / stability drill of choice          | 2 sets               | Brace without fatigue                     |
| Light med-ball slam                       | 3 x 5                | Fast shoulders + trunk                    |
| Scapular retraction drill                 | 2 x 10-15            | Prime scap control                        |
| Rotational landmine hand-to-hand transfer | 2 x 3-4 / side       | Explosive rotational transfer; light load |
| Explosive OR stability push-up            | 2 x 3-6              | Upper-body power or stability             |
| Rotator cuff external rotation            | 2 x 12-15            | Shoulder prep                             |
| Band shoulder mobility                    | 1-2 min              | Open usable range                         |
| Bench ramp sets                           | 3-5 progressive sets | Build to work weight                      |

| WORK                                        | SETS | REPS      | RPE | NOTES                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------|------|-----------|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bench variation                             | 3-5  | 3-5       | 8   | Use current progression phase. Recalibrate load every variation.    |
| DB or barbell shoulder press                | 3-4  | 12-20     | 8-9 | High-volume press; control the bottom position.                     |
| Overhead triceps extension OR skull crusher | 3    | 8-15      | 8-9 | Long-head triceps emphasis.                                         |
| Weighted dips                               | 3    | 6-10      | 8-9 | If unavailable: bodyweight dip AMRAP with clean reps.               |
| Cable triceps pushdown                      | 3    | 12-20     | 8-9 | Full lockout; no torso swing.                                       |
| Cable fly                                   | 3    | 12-20     | 8-9 | Controlled stretch and squeeze.                                     |
| Lateral raise                               | 3    | 15-25     | 8-9 | High-quality delt volume.                                           |
| Cardio of choice                            | 1    | 10-20 min | 5-7 | Finish with conditioning; do not turn every finish into a max test. |

# SESSION 02 - LOWER BODY PULL

The primary sumo deadlift stays submaximal so technique remains sharp. The secondary hinge is where the harder overload lives.

|                      |                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>WARM-UP ORDER</b> | Plyometric / explosive work -> core and stability -> mobility -> movement patterning -> ramp-up sets into the main lift. |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| WARM-UP                    | SETS / REPS          | INTENT                                  |
|----------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Posterior-chain plyometric | 2-3 x 3-5            | Broad jump or similar explosive pattern |
| Explosive step-up          | 2 x 4 / side         | Fast hip extension, controlled landing  |
| Abductor machine           | 1-2 x 15-20          | Hip prep                                |
| Adductor machine           | 1-2 x 15-20          | Hip prep                                |
| Lateral-plane drill        | 2 x 5 / side         | Lateral lunge / Cossack pattern         |
| Core stability             | 2 sets               | Pallof press or equivalent              |
| Hyperextension             | 2 x 10-12            | Groove hinge + warm posterior chain     |
| Sumo ramp sets             | 3-5 progressive sets | Build to technical work weight          |

| WORK                       | SETS | REPS         | RPE   | NOTES                                                                                        |
|----------------------------|------|--------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sumo deadlift              | 3-5  | 3-5          | 7-7.5 | Technical anchor. Keep fatigue deliberately low. Sumo rack pull may occasionally substitute. |
| Secondary deadlift / hinge | 3-4  | See rotation | 8-9   | Harder volume slot. Athlete edition: BOSU RDL may use a barbell if fully mastered.           |
| Hamstring curl             | 4    | 8-15         | 8-9   | Full shortening and controlled eccentric.                                                    |
| Calf raise                 | 4    | 8-15         | 8-9   | Pause in stretch and top position.                                                           |
| Tibialis raise             | 3    | 15-25        | 8-9   | Controlled dorsiflexion.                                                                     |
| Cardio of choice           | 1    | 10-20 min    | 5-7   | Keep it sustainable after posterior-chain work.                                              |

# SESSION 03 - UPPER BODY PULL

This is the highest-volume upper-body session. Weighted chin-ups and one-arm rows anchor the day, then the rest of the session fills the upper back, lats, rear delts, forearms, and biceps.

|                      |                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>WARM-UP ORDER</b> | Plyometric / explosive work -> core and stability -> mobility -> movement patterning -> ramp-up sets into the main lift. |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| WARM-UP                                          | SETS / REPS   | INTENT                                |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------|
| Light med-ball slam / upper-body explosive drill | 3 x 4-6       | Wake up the trunk and shoulder girdle |
| Pallof press                                     | 2 x 8 / side  | Anti-rotation core                    |
| Dead hang                                        | 2 x 20-30 sec | Shoulder + lat length                 |
| Scap pull-up                                     | 2 x 6-10      | Prime depression/retraction           |
| Thoracic rotation                                | 1 x 6 / side  | T-spine mobility                      |
| Band pull-apart / face-pull pattern              | 2 x 12-15     | Rear shoulder + upper back            |

| WORK                     | SETS | REPS      | RPE | NOTES                                                 |
|--------------------------|------|-----------|-----|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Kelso shrug              | 3    | 10-15     | 7-8 | Prime upper-back retraction without arm dominance.    |
| Weighted chin-up         | 4-5  | 4-8       | 8-9 | Primary vertical pull. Add load only with full range. |
| Single-arm dumbbell row  | 4    | 8-12      | 8-9 | Hard horizontal pull; control rotation.               |
| Upper-back row of choice | 3-4  | 10-15     | 8-9 | Bias upper back / rear shoulder.                      |
| Lat accessory of choice  | 3-4  | 10-15     | 8-9 | Pulldown, pullover, or similar lat bias.              |
| Rear-delt work           | 3-4  | 15-25     | 8-9 | High-quality volume.                                  |
| Forearm work             | 3    | 12-20     | 8-9 | Grip / wrist flexion-extension as needed.             |
| Biceps work              | 3-4  | 8-15      | 8-9 | Choose curl variation based on elbow comfort.         |
| Cardio of choice         | 1    | 10-20 min | 5-7 | Short conditioning finish.                            |

# SESSION 04 - LEGS / LOWER BODY PUSH

The squat is the high-intensity centerpiece. The rest of the session builds unilateral capacity, quads, lower-leg strength, hamstrings, and hip support.

|                      |                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>WARM-UP ORDER</b> | Plyometric / explosive work -> core and stability -> mobility -> movement patterning -> ramp-up sets into the main lift. |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| WARM-UP                | SETS / REPS          | INTENT                                             |
|------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Box jump               | 3 x 3                | Max-quality takeoff; stop before jump height falls |
| Jump lunge             | 2 x 4 / side         | Elastic leg drive                                  |
| Core / stability drill | 2 sets               | Brace and control pelvis                           |
| Lateral-plane drill    | 2 x 5 / side         | Lateral lunge / Cossack pattern                    |
| Deep calf stretch      | 30-45 sec / side     | Prepare ankle range                                |
| TKE                    | 2 x 15 / side        | Knee extension + quad activation                   |
| Squat patterning       | 2 x 5                | Groove depth and bracing                           |
| Squat ramp sets        | 3-5 progressive sets | Build to work weight                               |

| WORK                                   | SETS | REPS       | RPE | NOTES                                                         |
|----------------------------------------|------|------------|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Squat variation                        | 3-5  | 3-5        | 8-9 | Primary heavy lower-body lift. Recalibrate load every phase.  |
| Good morning OR hip-extension movement | 3    | 6-10       | 8   | Posterior-chain strength without stealing from squat quality. |
| Walking lunge                          | 3    | 8-12 / leg | 8-9 | Long, controlled steps.                                       |
| Sissy squat - Smith preferred          | 3    | 10-20      | 8-9 | Quad bias; use pain-free range.                               |
| Leg extension                          | 3    | 12-20      | 9   | Hard quad finish; controlled eccentric.                       |
| Calf raise                             | 4    | 8-15       | 8-9 | Loaded stretch + full plantarflexion.                         |
| Tibialis raise                         | 3    | 15-25      | 8-9 | Anterior lower-leg volume.                                    |
| Hamstring curl                         | 3    | 10-15      | 8-9 | Balance knee-flexion volume.                                  |
| Abductor work                          | 3    | 15-25      | 8-9 | Finish hips with controlled reps.                             |
| Cardio of choice                       | 1    | 10-20 min  | 5-7 | Choose modality based on recovery.                            |

# BENCH PRESS VARIATION PROGRESSION

The bench sequence develops position and control first, then stability and strength, then power, and finally returns to the regular bench press. The athlete edition may repeat, skip, or insert a variation when a specific weakness demands it; the performance edition follows the default order unless execution says to repeat an exposure.

| # | VARIATION              | PRIMARY PURPOSE                 | LOADING NOTE                                      |
|---|------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Larsen press           | Control + upper-body tension    | No leg drive; load by RPE 8                       |
| 2 | Tempo bench press      | Eccentric control + position    | Use prescribed tempo; reset load                  |
| 3 | Spoto press            | Pause control just off chest    | Own the hover; no sink                            |
| 4 | HBT bench press        | Stability + force organization  | Hanging Band Technique; use conservative setup    |
| 5 | Close-grip bench press | Triceps strength + bar path     | Narrow only as far as wrist/elbow mechanics allow |
| 6 | Floor press            | Mid-range strength + control    | Dead stop each rep                                |
| 7 | Pin press              | Starting strength / overload    | Set pins to target weak range                     |
| 8 | Banded bench press     | Power + accelerating resistance | Bands add more resistance toward lockout          |
| 9 | Regular bench press    | Expression / specificity        | Bring the qualities back to the full lift         |

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>HBT</b> | HBT = Hanging Band Technique. Weight is suspended from bands so the implement oscillates and forces constant stabilization. It is a stability tool, not a license to use uncontrolled loading. |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>LOAD RULE</b> | A mechanically easier variation should usually permit more load, but the number is discovered through ramp sets. The target is still 3-5 sets of 3-5 reps around RPE 8 - not matching the previous variation pound-for-pound. |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

# SQUAT + DEADLIFT PROGRESSIONS

The squat progression moves from demanding stability and position toward full back-squat expression. The deadlift uses a different model: the sumo deadlift remains the technical anchor while the secondary hinge rotates and carries more of the hard volume.

## SQUAT ROTATION

| # | VARIATION          | PURPOSE                                   | TARGET              |
|---|--------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 1 | Front HBT squat    | Front-loaded stability + bracing          | 3-5 x 3-5 @ RPE 8-9 |
| 2 | Zombie squat       | Upper-back position + torso control       | 3-5 x 3-5 @ RPE 8-9 |
| 3 | Box SSB squat      | Positional strength + controlled reversal | 3-5 x 3-5 @ RPE 8-9 |
| 4 | Tempo squat        | Control through full range                | 3-5 x 3-5 @ RPE 8-9 |
| 5 | Back HBT squat     | Back-squat pattern under instability      | 3-5 x 3-5 @ RPE 8-9 |
| 6 | Regular back squat | Expression / primary squat                | 3-5 x 3-5 @ RPE 8-9 |

## SECONDARY DEADLIFT / HINGE ROTATION

| # | VARIATION                                    | SETS / REPS      | PURPOSE                                        |
|---|----------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Barbell RDL                                  | 3-4 x 6-10 @ 8-9 | Loaded hinge strength + hamstrings             |
| 2 | Barbell BOSU RDL - advanced athlete use only | 3 x 8-12 @ 8     | Stability + hinge control; never chase failure |
| 3 | Rack pull                                    | 4 x 4-8 @ 8-9    | Overload / lockout strength                    |
| 4 | Banded conventional deadlift                 | 4 x 3-6 @ 8      | Power + force through lockout                  |

### SUMO STAYS

Sumo deadlift remains in the lower-pull session at RPE 7-7.5 for 3-5 sets of 3-5. It is practice under meaningful load, not the place to accumulate the most fatigue. A sumo rack pull can occasionally replace it when that better serves the athlete.

# WARM-UP + CONDITIONING RULES

Every session follows the same architecture. The exact drills change with the day, but the order stays consistent so the athlete becomes explosive, organized, mobile, patterned, and then loaded.

| STAGE                     | PURPOSE                               | GUIDELINE                                           |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Plyometric / explosive | Raise neural intent without fatigue   | 2-3 drills max, low reps, full-quality landings     |
| 2. Core / stability       | Organize trunk and pelvis             | 1-2 drills, stop well before failure                |
| 3. Mobility               | Open the range needed for the session | Use targeted, short-duration work                   |
| 4. Patterning             | Rehearse the movement family          | Scap, hinge, squat, press, or lateral plane         |
| 5. Ramp sets              | Match the exact main lift             | 3-5 progressive sets; more if technically necessary |

## PLYOMETRIC QUALITY RULES

- + Plyometrics are primers. Stop the set when jump height, speed, coordination, or landing quality drops.
- + Use commercial-gym-friendly options and keep the loading light enough to move fast.
- + Do not stack a large plyometric workout in front of heavy strength work.

## CARDIO FINISH

Finish each session with 10-20 minutes of cardio. Modality is flexible: incline walking, bike, rower, stair machine, easy running, or another sustainable option. Most days should feel like RPE 5-7 so conditioning develops without erasing strength-session recovery.

### OPTIONAL HARDER CONDITIONING

If conditioning is a current priority and recovery is excellent, harder intervals can occasionally replace the steady finish. Do not make that the default after every demanding lifting day.

# MOVEMENT NOTES + DEFINITIONS

## HBT - Hanging Band Technique

Plates or kettlebells are suspended from resistance bands attached to the bar. The oscillation creates a high stability demand. Start lighter than a normal variation and keep every rep controlled.

## Larsen Press

Bench press performed without using leg drive, typically with the legs extended or elevated from the floor. The torso must create its own stability.

## Spoto Press

Lower the bar toward the chest, stop just above contact, hold briefly without relaxing, then press. It builds control in the hardest bottom range.

## Rotational Landmine Hand-to-Hand Transfer

With the bar anchored in a landmine, guide the end of the bar across the body and transfer hands explosively under control. Use a light load and keep the trunk organized.

## Kelso Shrug

A scapular retraction shrug performed from a row position. Keep the arms mostly straight and move the shoulder blades rather than turning it into a full row.

## TKE - Terminal Knee Extension

Band or cable knee-extension drill used to activate the quads and rehearse strong lockout before squatting.

## Sissy Squat

Quad-dominant knee-flexion movement. The Smith machine can provide stability. Use only a pain-free range and progress slowly.

## Banded Bench / Deadlift

Resistance bands increase load as the band stretches, producing more resistance toward the top of the lift and encouraging continued acceleration.

## BOSU RDL

A stability-focused Romanian deadlift performed on a BOSU. Athlete edition may use a barbell only with advanced mastery; instability is the challenge, not maximal loading.

## TECHNIQUE STANDARD

If a variation forces you to abandon the intended movement pattern, the load or variation is wrong for that exposure. The purpose of advanced variation is to improve the primary lift, not to survive a circus trick.

# TRAIN WITH TENSOR STRENGTH

The Hutch Touch is built around the same standard Tensor Strength brings to coaching: performance first, deliberate progression, and no wasted work.

## IN-PERSON TRAINING

**Exclusively available at The Fit Effect in Paris, Ontario.**

## ONLINE / REMOTE COACHING

**\$400**

## TENSOR STRENGTH MEMBERSHIP

**\$9.99 / month | \$90 / year**

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Strength. Stability. Power. Work Capacity. Performance.

## FINAL NOTE

Train hard enough to force adaptation. Train intelligently enough to keep adapting.